BRAND & OPERATING SYSTEM

Nadir & Nawat

One designer, one studio, one system for running both.

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Version 1.0 — August 2026

Supersedes: Personal Brand Strategy (August 2026). Archive that file.

00

How to Use This

A strategy you have to re-read is a strategy you won't follow.

This document exists so you stop re-deciding things you have already decided. Every recurring question — what do I call myself, who am I talking to, what do I post, how do I approach a client, what do I say when they push back on price — is answered here once, so that on any given Tuesday you are executing rather than re-litigating.

It absorbs and replaces the August 2026 Personal Brand Strategy document. Everything still true from that file has been carried over; the parts overtaken by later decisions have been corrected. From here, this is the single source of truth.

HOW IT'S ORGANISED

— **Part One — Foundation.** Who you are, who you're for, how you sound, what you're allowed to claim. Read this fully once. Revisit only when something feels off.

— **Part Two — Content.** What to publish, where, how often. This is a working manual, not a read-once document.

— **Part Three — Acquisition.** How a stranger becomes a client. Scripts included, meant to be used, not admired.

— **Part Four — Offers & Operations.** What you sell, how you deliver it, how you get paid, how you know it's working.

HOW TO KEEP IT ALIVE

1. Reread Part One at the start of every quarter. Ten minutes. If a rule no longer matches reality, change the rule here first, then change the website.

2. Parts Two through Four are working documents. Mark them up. If a script gets a reply, note what you changed.

3. When a decision gets made in conversation — a new rule, a price, a client you turned down and why — write it into this file the same week. A decision that lives only in your head gets re-made badly six weeks later.

If a piece of copy, a post, or a proposal contradicts something in Part One, the copy is wrong, not Part One.

WHAT'S DELIBERATELY MISSING

Pricing numbers. The pricing **model** is in Section 20, but the actual figures are a separate decision you've chosen to take on its own. Until then, treat every price in this document as a placeholder, not a recommendation.

OPENING STATEMENT

You have the proof and none of the audience.

A design system of 1,033 variables, an ERP that got 50 percent faster, three case studies written to a standard most designers never reach — and a following of 1.2K people who don't engage, on a platform where you post into silence.

The next twelve months are not about doing better work. They're about being seen doing it.

FOUNDATION · CONTENT · ACQUISITION · OPERATIONS

↳ *This is the whole thesis of the document. Everything after it is machinery for closing that one gap.*

01

One Business, Two Names

Nadir is the person. Nawat is the business. They are not competitors.

In July 2026 you closed a structural problem: running a personal freelance brand and a studio brand at the same time meant two storefronts selling the same service to the same buyer. That isn't a hedge, it's a conflict. The resolution was to consolidate on Nawat as the single business, with Nadir becoming simply the person behind it — the way any solo studio owner's name sits on their own work.

That decision holds. But it needs a working rule, because in practice you will be asked to introduce yourself several times a week and the answer isn't always the same word.

THE RULE

Nadir is the face. Nawat is the invoice. People follow people — they read a designer's post, watch a designer's Loom, trust a designer's judgement. Companies hire companies — they sign with a studio, receive a proposal from a studio, pay a studio. The audience meets Nadir. The client contracts with Nawat.

WHICH NAME, WHEN

SITUATION	LEAD WITH	BECAUSE
Social content, posts, comments	**Nadir**	Attention is personal. Nobody follows a logo they've never heard of.
Your own site (nadirdesign.com)	**Nadir**, Nawat as support line	It's a credibility page for a person who happens to run a studio.
Cold audit / Loom outreach	**Nadir**	A person noticed something about their product. A studio pitching reads as a sales funnel.
Proposal, contract, invoice	**Nawat**	Signals a business with process, not a freelancer with free time.
Case studies on nawat.studio	**Nawat**	Studio work delivered after January

		2026 belongs to the studio.
Speaking about past pre-2026 work	**Nadir**	Task Master and B2B Sales ERP predate Nawat. Crediting the studio would be false.
A client asks 'is it just you?'	**Honest answer**	See the scope-honesty guardrail in Section 07. Never imply a team you don't have.

THE INVOICING QUESTION, SETTLED

You are a registered freelancer in Algeria. That registration is the legal vehicle that lets you invoice today, without waiting for Nawat to become a registered entity. This is a paperwork detail, not a second brand: the client's proposal says Nawat, the work is delivered as Nawat, the case study credits Nawat, and the invoice happens to be issued under your personal registration.

↳ *The failure mode to avoid: pitching some clients as 'Nadir, independent freelancer' and others as 'Nawat Studio.' That reopens the two-storefront conflict through the back door. The client-facing story never splits.*

WHEN NAWAT SHOULD BECOME A REAL ENTITY

Not yet, and not on a date — on a trigger. Register Nawat properly when any one of these is true: a client's procurement process requires a company counterparty and the deal is worth more than the registration costs; you are consistently subcontracting other designers and need to pay them cleanly; or annual revenue reaches a level where the freelance status becomes the more expensive option. Until one of those fires, the registration is overhead without a return.

02

What You Sell

Most designers make things look better. You make complicated things usable.

THE POSITIONING STATEMENT

Product Designer. Founder of Nawat Studio. I turn complex, data-heavy products into clear interfaces — ERP, dashboards, internal tools, design systems — in Arabic and English.

That is the sentence everything else is tested against. It survives from the August strategy with one addition: the bilingual clause moved from a nice-to-have into the statement itself, because it is the single hardest thing on this page for a competitor to copy.

THE THREE THINGS YOU ACTUALLY SELL

Clients don't buy 'product design.' They buy a specific relief from a specific pain. Yours are:

— **Density made legible.** ERP screens, sales dashboards, warehouse operations, multi-role permissions. Interfaces where the problem is too much information, not too little. This is rare — most designers avoid this work because it isn't portfolio-pretty, and that avoidance is your moat.

— **Systems that survive handoff.** Not a Figma file, a foundation: tokens, states, documentation, governance. Iksir is 1,033 variables and a documentation platform that designers and developers both work from. Most studios deliver screens and disappear.

— **Arabic and English as first-class citizens.** Not a translation layer bolted on at the end — RTL built into the tokens, typography tuned per script, accessibility baked in rather than audited afterwards. For a Gulf company this is the difference between a design partner who understands their market and a foreign agency who will need it explained.

WHY THAT LAST ONE MATTERS MOST

There are thousands of good product designers. There are far fewer who do enterprise density well. There are very few who do enterprise density well and can build the same system natively in Arabic and

English, having actually shipped it — with a real bidirectional design system in production, not an opinion about RTL.

That intersection is your entire commercial position. Every piece of content, every audit, every proposal should reinforce at least one of the three, and ideally the intersection of all three.

THE ONE-SENTENCE VERSIONS

— **Shortest.** I design complex software so people can actually use it.

— **Standard.** I'm a product designer working on data-heavy B2B products — ERP, dashboards, internal tools — and the design systems underneath them.

— **With the differentiator.** I design data-heavy B2B products and the design systems underneath them, built bilingual in Arabic and English from the first token.

— **Studio version.** Nawat is a product design studio for teams building complex software. We work from visual identity through to user testing, and we build in Arabic and English natively.

WHAT YOU DO NOT SELL

Naming this protects you from the worst kind of project: the one you accepted because you were unsure whether to say no.

— Marketing sites and landing pages as a standalone service. You can do them, they are not the position.

— Logo-only work with no product attached. Identity is part of a product engagement, not a product itself.

— Business strategy consulting, growth consulting, or anything where the deliverable is advice rather than design.

— Development. You hand off to developers, you don't employ them.

— Anything you'd need to learn on the client's budget to deliver.

03

Who You're Talking To

A market you can name is a market you can find.

THE TARGET, PRIVATELY

UAE, Qatar, and Saudi Arabia specifically — not 'the Middle East,' not 'MENA.' These are markets with real software budgets, an Arabic-first user base, and a shortage of designers who can serve both requirements at once.

This targeting is an internal decision that drives where you look for clients, which time zone you keep, and which language leads. It is deliberately **not** literal site copy — naming three countries on a public page reads as a border to a client from Egypt, Jordan, or anywhere else you'd happily work. Both sites already handle this correctly: nadirdesign.com frames the differentiator as Arabic and English design fluency, and nawat.studio carries a 'MENA · Global' badge. Keep it that way.

THE DIALECT QUESTION

You're Algerian, targeting the Gulf, and Arabic doesn't have one accent, it has many. Worth answering directly rather than quietly worrying about it: this is a real friction point, not a reason to retreat to the Algerian market.

The risk splits cleanly into written and spoken, and only one half is ever exposed to a client.

— **Written Arabic is not the problem.** Site copy, case studies, proposals, contracts, and most social posts are Modern Standard Arabic, not dialect. That's already how this brand's Arabic is built: مصمم منتجات, نظام التصميم, none of it is Algerian Darija. Professional written Arabic converges on MSA across the entire Arab world. A reader in Riyadh and a reader in Algiers read the same sentence the same way.

— **Spoken Arabic is where an accent is audible.** A Loom, a TikTok voiceover, a call, anywhere you're actually talking. An Algerian accent in Darija reads as distant to a Gulf ear, more than Egyptian or Levantine, which Gulf audiences hear constantly through media.

THE FIX

— **Speak MSA, or a lightly-accented professional MSA, for anything client-facing.** Not a workaround, standard practice, it's how Arabic business creators with all kinds of regional accents already keep pan-Arab reach.

— **Caption everything spoken.** Arabic subtitles on every Loom, every TikTok, every video post. Most people watch muted anyway, and captioning turns an accent question into a reading question, which removes it almost entirely.

— **Let the written proof carry the weight it already carries.** The numbers in Section 04 don't have an accent.

WHY IT DOESN'T DISQUALIFY YOU

Gulf business and tech culture is already thoroughly mixed, Egyptian, Levantine, Jordanian, Indian, Western, and North African professionals work there constantly. An accent costs a half-second first impression, not the deal. You've also already done this once: Iksir's client, DataMaster, is French, not Gulf, and that gap in geography and culture didn't stop the relationship from working.

An accent is a presentation detail to manage. Staying Algeria-only would undo the pricing in Section 20, which exists specifically because remote work pays roughly five times what the local Algerian market does.

↳ Practical rule for Section 05 and Section 09: default to MSA in speech, caption in Arabic always, save Darija for private conversation, not published content.

THE THREE BUYERS

Everything from cold message to proposal changes depending on which of these you're talking to. Identify them early.

BUYER	WHAT KEEPS THEM UP AT NIGHT	WHAT WINS THEM
Founder of an early-stage product company (2 to 20 people)	The product works but looks amateur, and enterprise buyers are noticing. No designer on the team.	Speed, decisiveness, and a fixed price. They want the decision made for them.
Product or engineering lead at a growing company (20 to 200)	Every screen is built differently. Devs argue about spacing. Shipping is slow because nothing is reusable.	The design system case. Show Iksir. Talk tokens, handoff, and dev velocity.
Operations or business owner with an internal tool	Staff hate the software. Training takes weeks. Errors cost money.	Task Master: 50 percent faster task execution with real supermarket users. Outcome language, not craft language.

START HERE: THE EARLY-STAGE SEGMENT

Your own instinct is right — begin with clients who are still starting and need the work badly, rather than large organisations with procurement, legal review, and vendor onboarding. The reasoning is structural, not defensive:

— They decide in days, not quarters. One person says yes.

— They rarely require a registered company counterparty, so your freelance registration is sufficient.

— They have no incumbent design partner to displace.

— Their problems are exactly the ones your case studies solve, at a smaller scale.

— They become the second, third, and fourth Nawat case study — which is what unlocks the larger clients later.

↳ *This is a sequencing decision, not a permanent ceiling. The goal of the first year of small clients is to earn the right to stop needing them.*

DISQUALIFIERS

Say no early and say it warmly. Every one of these has a cost you'll pay later:

— **No decision-maker in the conversation.** If your contact has to 'check with someone,' find out who and get them in the room before scoping.

— **Wants a logo and a website by Thursday.** Wrong service, wrong buyer, wrong expectations about what design is.

— **Comparing you to a template or a marketplace price.** They're buying a commodity. You are not one.

— **Cannot describe their user.** If nobody can tell you who uses this and what for, the project has no destination and you will be blamed for not arriving.

— **Wants you to work inside their tools, hours, and standups for a fixed monthly fee.** That's employment with none of the protections, and you've already established it doesn't suit you.

— **Haggles before scope exists.** Price arguments before the problem is defined never improve.

04

The Copy Bank

Write it once, well. Then stop rewriting it in every bio field at midnight.

Approved copy, ready to paste. Arabic leads, English second, French kept only where a francophone contact already exists. Nothing here uses em dashes or semicolons in displayed form, per the punctuation policy in Section 05.

PROFESSIONAL TITLE — LOCKED

— English: **Product Designer**. Founder appears after, never before, and never alone.

— Arabic: **مصمم منتجات** (plural). Never مصمم منتج. This applies everywhere, including generic references.

— Studio in Arabic: **استوديو نواة**. Not أستديو.

SOCIAL HEADLINES

— **LinkedIn:** Product Designer · Founder, Nawat Studio | Enterprise UX, data-heavy interfaces, design systems | Arabic & English

— **Instagram / TikTok:** Product Designer. I make complex software usable. Arabic & English. Founder of Nawat Studio.

— **Behance:** Product Designer — B2B SaaS, ERP, Design Systems

— **Arabic bio line:** مصمم منتجات رقمية. أشتغل على المنتجات المعقدة وكثيفة البيانات وأنظمة التصميم. مؤسس استوديو نواة.

SHORT BIO — 40 WORDS

Product designer working on data-heavy B2B products: ERP modules, dashboards, and internal tools, plus the design systems underneath them. Founder of Nawat Studio. Builds bilingual Arabic and English interfaces with accessibility and RTL handled from the first token, not the last sprint.

LONG BIO — 100 WORDS

Nadir Mostefaoui is a product designer working on the software most designers avoid: ERP modules, sales dashboards, warehouse operations, and multi-role enterprise platforms where the design problem is too much information rather than too little.

He led Iksir, a token-first design system of 1,033 variables and 24 fully-stated components spanning web and mobile, built bilingual with native RTL support and WCAG 2.1 AA baked into the tokens themselves. Earlier work on a retail operations app cut task execution time in half in testing with real users.

He is the founder of Nawat Studio, a product design studio working from visual identity through to user testing.

THE ELEVATOR ANSWER

When someone asks what you do, don't lead with the job title. Lead with the problem:

You know how enterprise software always looks like a spreadsheet had an accident? I fix that. ERP systems, dashboards, internal tools — the screens with forty things on them that people have to use all day. And I build them in Arabic and English at the same time, which almost nobody does properly.

USE IN CONVERSATION, ON CALLS, AT EVENTS

PROOF LINES — MEMORISE THESE

Numbers do the persuading so you don't have to. All verified, all publishable.

— **1,033** design variables in the Iksir system.

— **24** components, every state documented.

— **50 percent** faster task execution in usability testing with real supermarket staff.

— **5** ERP modules designed end to end: Sales, Purchase, POS, Finance, Accounting.

— **3** platforms, **2** modes, **191** colour tokens, **86** icons, WCAG 2.1 AA.

— **Version 9.1** — the B2B Sales module iterated with developers to a ninth major revision. Use this when someone doubts you can work with engineering.

THE CTA LIBRARY

— Soft, for content: 'If you're building something like this, my inbox is open.'

— Direct, for a warm lead: 'Want me to look at yours? I'll record fifteen minutes of notes, no charge, no pitch.'

— Closing, for a proposal: 'If this looks right, reply and I'll send the agreement today.'

05

How You Sound

Casual and honest. Not corporate, not humble, not clever.

THE FIVE RULES

1. **Say the thing.** Lead with the point, then support it. No throat-clearing, no 'in today's fast-paced digital landscape.'

2. **Show the number or don't claim the result.** 'Faster' is marketing. '50 percent faster in testing with real users' is evidence. If there's no number, describe the mechanism instead.

3. **Admit the constraint.** The NDA, the thing that didn't work, the part your partner built. Naming limits is what makes the rest believable, and it is the single easiest way to sound different from every agency account in the region.

4. **Explain, don't impress.** If a sentence needs a design degree to parse, rewrite it. Your buyer is often a founder or an ops manager, not a designer.

5. **Never punch down.** Critique the interface, never the person who made it. Especially in audits — the designer whose work you're reviewing might be in the room, or might be the one who hires you.

PUNCTUATION — SITEWIDE POLICY

No em dashes and no semicolons in any displayed copy, in all three languages. Replacements: paired asides become parentheses, single mid-sentence dashes become commas, label-description lines use a colon, and separators use the middle dot. Arabic ؛ becomes ،. This already applies across both sites and should apply to posts, captions, and proposals too.

TONE BY LANGUAGE

— **Arabic** is the default and should read as naturally as you speak, not as translated English. Keep technical terms in Latin where the Arabic is non-standard: design tokens, breakpoints, wireframes, front-end, Modal, Agile. Keep the established Arabic where it's correct: نظام التصميم، تجربة المستخدم، إمكانية الوصول، معمارية المعلومات. Mobile is الجوال. Typography is التايبوغرافيا, never الطباعة. Never apply Latin-style letter-spacing to Arabic.

— **English** is slightly more precise and slightly less warm than the Arabic. It carries the international and technical credibility load.

— **French** is maintenance only. Existing contacts, no new content.

WORDS TO RETIRE

Each of these signals agency-speak, which is the exact register your positioning is built against: passionate, innovative, cutting-edge, seamless, elevate, unlock, journey (unless literally a user journey), synergy, leverage as a verb, 'we're excited to announce.'

THE HONESTY TEST

Before publishing anything: could a client who worked with you read this and recognise the experience they actually had?

↳ *If the answer is no, you're describing an aspiration. Aspirations belong in a plan, not in public copy.*

06

How It Looks

The restraint is the brand. Don't decorate it.

THE DECISION THAT DEFINES IT

In August 2026 you removed the logos. Two full logo systems had been built and neither ever shipped, and when the discussion reopened you chose removal over a third round. The navbar now carries your name set in the site's own typeface, with no mark at all. Section kickers use a numbered index with a dotted leader, the table-of-contents device, rather than decorative squares.

That is not an absence of identity. It is the identity: a designer whose work is about precision and systems presents himself with typography, numbering, and space rather than a symbol. Hold this line. If a logo project comes back on the table, it should be because a client needs one, not because the brand feels incomplete.

THE SYSTEM

ELEMENT	VALUE	NOTE
Latin typeface	IBM Plex Sans	Site and product contexts.
Arabic typeface	IBM Plex Sans Arabic	Never pair with a calligraphic display face. Tried and rejected.
Document typefaces	Georgia + Calibri	This template. Editorial, deliberately not the website's face.
Accent	#1D4ED8	One accent, used for meaning: links, active states, stat numbers. Never decoration.
Ink / text	#0D0D0D light, #F5F5F5 dark	High contrast is the point.
Spacing	2 · 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64 · 80 · 96 · 120	Stay on the scale.

Radius	0 · 4 · 8 · 12 · 20 · 24 · pill
Container	1200px max, 68px nav

RULES FOR ANYTHING NEW

— Both themes, always. Light and dark are not optional variants.

— Both scripts, always. If a layout only works in one direction, it isn't finished.

— No new accent colours. If something needs to stand out and blue is taken, the layout is wrong.

— No stock photography, no illustration library, no gradients-as-decoration. Real product screens, real type, real space.

— Documents use this template. Slides and social graphics inherit the same restraint: one accent, two typefaces, more space than feels comfortable.

SOCIAL TEMPLATE SPECIFICATION

You need three reusable frames, built once in Figma, so publishing never stalls on layout:

— **Statement frame.** Near-black background, one line of large text, small name credit bottom-left. For opinions and principles.

— **Teardown frame.** Product screenshot, one blue annotation marker, one line of explanation beneath. For audits and critiques.

— **Number frame.** One large figure in accent blue, one line of context under it. For proof and results.

↳ *Three frames, both scripts, both themes: twelve artboards total. Build once, use for a year.*

07

What You're Allowed to Claim

The line between confident and dishonest is a date.

ATTRIBUTION — LOCKED

Nawat Studio was founded in January 2026. Nothing delivered before that date is Nawat's work, no matter how good it is or how much you'd like the studio's portfolio to look fuller.

PROJECT	CREDIT	WHY
Iksir Design System	Nawat client work	Built Feb to Jun 2026, after Nawat was founded. DataMaster is the client.
Task Master App	Personal history	Built while you were DataMaster's employee, before Jan 2026.
B2B Sales ERP	Personal history	Same. Predates the studio.
eLearning Platform	Personal history	Five Angles, Dubai. Unrelated to both.

↳ *The DataMaster timeline: employee or contractor from September 2024 to December 2025, then a Nawat client from January 2026 onward. Both sites now reflect this. Don't let a proposal quietly re-merge them.*

THE ROADMAP IS PUBLIC — DELIBERATELY

The DataMaster roadmap (IA redesign, product redesign, new products) is published on nawat.studio as Coming Soon phases. This was reviewed and kept visible as a deliberate choice. It is not a leak, and it should not be re-flagged. It works in your favour: it shows a client relationship with a future, not a one-off engagement.

SCOPE HONESTY — THE HARD GUARDRAIL

You've described yourself accurately as a freelance designer with contacts you can pull in, not an agency operator. Every claim in every proposal must stay inside what your case studies demonstrate and what your known freelancers have actually proven they can do.

— **In scope, proven:** enterprise and data-heavy UX, design systems and tokens, B2B product design, brand and visual identity for product companies, accessibility testing (documented axe, Lighthouse, VoiceOver, TalkBack workflow), bilingual Arabic and English with RTL, developer handoff and documentation.

— **Out of scope until proven:** full-service agency claims, business or growth strategy consulting, development, motion and 3D, large multi-team engagements.

— **Never claim a team you don't have.** 'We hire designers per project' is true and it's enough. 'Our team of designers' is not.

THE CONFIDENTIAL LAYER

— NDA holds on DataMaster internals: no internal metrics, no quotes, no security details, no repo links, no unreleased strategy. Name the client, generalise the data. Both case studies already do this correctly.

— Never publish which parts of Iksir your partner built versus which parts you led, beyond the honest credit already on the site. Internally the split is clear: you owned strategy, discovery, the client relationship, the whole knowledge layer, the mobile layer, and V1 launch.

— Never publish anything about work volume, availability fluctuations, or how many clients you currently have.

THE PORTFOLIO GAP, STATED PLAINLY

One Nawat-attributed case study exists. That's enough to start a conversation and not enough to carry a pitch. Until the second and third exist, price and scope accordingly, and treat every early client as an explicit portfolio investment: negotiate case-study rights into the agreement from day one (Section 21).

The fastest route to bigger clients is not better outreach. It's a second and third Nawat case study.

PART TWO

Content

Being seen doing the work you already do.

Sections 08 to 12. This is a working manual. Expect to open it weekly.

08

The Strategy

You are not building an audience. You are building recognition inside a small, specific room.

THE HONEST STARTING POSITION

1.2K followers on LinkedIn who don't engage. 100 to 200 on Instagram and TikTok. That is not a failure, it's an unactivated asset — those 1.2K people connected for a reason and have simply never been given anything worth responding to.

The goal is not to reach 10,000 followers. Reaching a hundred thousand strangers in the wrong countries is worth less than being the designer that forty founders and product leads in Dubai, Riyadh, and Doha recognise by name. Optimise for recognition inside the room, not for size of room.

WHAT CONTENT IS ACTUALLY FOR

— **Warming the cold approach.** When you send an audit Loom to someone who has seen three of your posts, you're a familiar designer with a point of view. If they've seen nothing, you're a stranger with a video. Content is what makes Part Three work.

— **Proving the position.** You claim you make dense software usable. Every teardown you publish is that claim demonstrated rather than asserted.

— **Compounding.** A case study is written once and referenced for years. A good teardown gets forwarded internally at exactly the company you want to work with.

↳ *Content is not a separate business from client work. It is the top of the same funnel. If a week's content can't plausibly lead to a conversation, it was decoration.*

THE FOUR PILLARS

Every post belongs to exactly one. If it fits none, don't post it.

PILLAR	WHAT IT IS	SHARE	PROVES
Teardown	A real interface, publicly	40%	Judgement. This is the pillar

	available, analysed. What works, what doesn't, what you'd change.		that generates leads.
System	How enterprise design actually works: tokens, states, density, hierarchy, handoff.	25%	Depth. Attracts product and engineering leads.
Bilingual	Arabic and RTL design done properly. Type, mirroring, tashkeel, spacing, the things people get wrong.	20%	The differentiator nobody can copy.
Behind it	Your work, decisions, failures, the studio. Honest, specific, no highlight reel.	15%	That there's a person here.

WHY TEARDOWNS CARRY THE MOST WEIGHT

They are the same motion as your outreach. A public teardown and a private audit Loom differ only in who the subject is and who can see it. Publishing teardowns builds the skill, builds the reputation, and produces the exact artefact that makes a cold approach land — while requiring nothing from you but the judgement you already have.

It also solves the portfolio problem sideways. You have one Nawat case study. You can publish fifty teardowns without a single client's permission.

THE RULE FOR TEARDOWN SUBJECTS

— Only publicly accessible products. Never a client's internal tool, never anything under NDA.

— Prefer regional products — Gulf and Arabic-language SaaS. The audience recognises them and the RTL angle appears naturally.

— Critique the interface, never the team. Assume constraints you can't see, and say so.

— Always end with what you'd do, not just what's wrong. Diagnosis without a prescription is complaining.

— Never teardown a product you're about to pitch, publicly. That belongs in a private Loom (Section 15).

09

Platform by Platform

Same substance, different shape. Never the same file cross-posted four times.

LINKEDIN — THE PRIMARY CHANNEL

This is where your buyers are. Founders, product leads, and operations managers in the Gulf use LinkedIn professionally in a way they do not use TikTok. Everything else is supporting.

— **Cadence:** three posts a week. Two Arabic, one English, unless a specific post needs the reverse.

— **Format priority:** carousels of five to eight slides for teardowns, plain text for opinions, single image for proof numbers. Native video only when you'd actually watch it back.

— **Structure:** first line is the whole hook, and it must work with the rest collapsed. No 'thread below.' No begging for comments.

— **Links go in the first comment**, never the post body.

— **The 20 minutes that matter more than the post:** comment substantively on ten posts from people in your target market every working day. Not 'great post.' An actual addition. This is how 1.2K dormant connections become a warm audience, and it is the single highest-return twenty minutes in this entire document.

↳ *For the first month, the commenting is more important than the posting. Reach with no relationship converts at roughly zero.*

INSTAGRAM — THE VISUAL PROOF

— **Cadence:** two to three posts a week, mostly repurposed from LinkedIn carousels.

— **What works here:** before-and-after screens, the number frames, short process clips. Arabic-first captions.

— **Stories:** work in progress, three or four times a week. Low effort, high familiarity.

— **Purpose:** this is a credibility surface, not an acquisition channel. When someone hears your name and checks, the grid should confirm the positioning within three seconds.

TIKTOK — THE ASYMMETRIC BET

Arabic-language design content on TikTok is genuinely underserved, and the platform still distributes to strangers rather than followers. That makes it the only channel where you could go from 200 to 20,000 without knowing anyone. It is also the channel most likely to produce nothing. Treat it as a cheap option, not an obligation.

— **Cadence:** one to two a week, thirty to sixty seconds, Arabic.

— **Format:** screen recording with voice over. 'This button is in the wrong place and here's why.' Fast, specific, one idea.

— **Rule:** if six weeks produce nothing, cut to once a month and reinvest the time in LinkedIn commenting. Don't let it become a hobby that feels like work.

BEHANCE — THE PORTFOLIO SURFACE

— One deck per case study, built from the site pages using the existing toolkit and render pipeline.

— Publish on a schedule, not in a batch. Behance surfaces recent work, so spacing them out buys four moments of visibility instead of one.

— Every project ends with a link to the full case study on your own site. Behance is a discovery layer, not a destination.

YOUR OWN SITE — THE ONE YOU OWN

The Insights section was removed as an empty placeholder. Bring it back only when there are three finished pieces to fill it — an empty blog is worse than no blog.

The pieces worth owning rather than renting: the long-form version of the Iksir system story, a genuine guide to bilingual Arabic and English design systems, and an enterprise-density primer. These are search-durable and forwardable, and they're the assets that make a stranger trust you before they ever meet you.

WHAT NOT TO START

No newsletter, no YouTube channel, no podcast, no X account. Not because they don't work, but because you have four channels already producing below their potential. New channels are the most common way a content plan dies.

10

The Weekly System

Consistency beats inspiration, and batching beats discipline.

THE WEEK

WHEN	WHAT	TIME
Monday	Publish post one. Comment on ten posts.	45 min
Tuesday	Comment only. Reply to everything on Monday's post.	25 min
Wednesday	Publish post two. Comment on ten posts.	45 min
Thursday	Comment only. Instagram story or two.	25 min
Friday	Publish post three. Weekly review (Section 24).	45 min
Saturday	Batch: produce next week's three posts in one sitting.	2 to 3 hrs
Sunday	Off. Genuinely off.	

↳ Roughly six hours a week. If that's not sustainable, cut to two posts rather than dropping the daily commenting — the commenting is what compounds.

THE BATCH SESSION

1. Open the backlog (Section 11). Pick three items, one from different pillars.
2. Write all three as plain text first. No design, no layout. Text only.
3. Let them sit an hour. Reread. Cut every sentence that isn't load-bearing.

4. Pour into the three Figma frames from Section 06. Never design from scratch.

5. Write the Arabic and English versions together, not by translating one into the other. Translated content reads translated.

6. Schedule all three. Refill the backlog with anything the session generated.

THE REPURPOSING CHAIN

One idea should produce four artefacts. Build in this order, largest first, because it's easy to cut down and painful to expand:

— **Teardown** → LinkedIn carousel → Instagram post (same slides, rewritten caption) → TikTok video (the single sharpest slide, spoken) → a line in a future article.

— **Case study** → Behance deck → three carousels (problem, decision, result) → a proof-number post → a reference in outreach.

— **A client question you answered well** → a post → a paragraph in your FAQ → a slide in your proposal template.

Never create for one platform. Create once, adapt three times.

THE IDEA CAPTURE HABIT

The backlog runs dry when capture is passive. Every time one of these happens, write it down within the hour: a client asks a question you've answered before, you notice something wrong in an app you use, a developer pushes back on a design decision, you make a judgement call you can articulate, someone gets Arabic layout wrong in a way that annoys you.

That last one is worth its own note. Irritation is the most reliable content signal you have — it means you know something the person who made it doesn't.

11

Thirty Posts, Ready

The backlog exists so that a bad week still produces something.

Each of these is publishable with what you already know. Cross them off as they go out.

TEARDOWN

- A Gulf SaaS product's onboarding, screen by screen, with what you'd change.
- The worst data table you can find in a public product, and a redesign of it.
- An Arabic app where the RTL mirroring breaks, and exactly which property causes it.
- A banking or delivery app's empty states: what they should say and don't.
- Two competing products' filter systems, side by side.
- A dashboard with twelve metrics on it, and which three actually matter.
- A form with too many fields, cut in half without losing data.
- The mobile version of a desktop-first enterprise tool, and where it collapsed.

SYSTEM

- Why 1,033 variables is not over-engineering, explained through one component.
- Primitives, semantic, component: the three layers, in plain language for a founder.
- Every state a button needs, and why teams ship four of them.
- How to price the cost of NOT having a design system, in developer hours.
- Documentation as a design deliverable: what goes in, what nobody reads.
- Density done right: how to fit forty data points on a screen legibly.
- The handoff checklist you actually use with developers.

- Why your ERP work reached version 9.1, and what changed between versions.

BILINGUAL

- The three things everyone gets wrong when they add Arabic to an existing product.
- Logical properties: why your CSS should never say 'left' again.
- Arabic type sizing — why it needs a size bump next to Latin, with examples.
- Tashkeel and line height: the descender problem, shown visually.
- Why letter-spacing on Arabic is always wrong.
- Which design terms should stay in English in Arabic copy, and which shouldn't.
- Mirroring: what flips, what never flips (numbers, charts, media controls).
- Building bilingual from token level versus retrofitting: a cost comparison.

BEHIND IT

- Why you turned down a design-system project at the price you were offered.
- Founding a studio in Algeria while working with clients abroad.
- The design decision on Iksir you'd make differently now.
- What accessibility testing actually looks like: axe, Lighthouse, VoiceOver, TalkBack.
- How you work with developers without being in their standups.
- The 50 percent result: what usability testing with warehouse staff was actually like.

↳ *Thirty posts is ten weeks at three a week. Refill during batch sessions, never from zero.*

12

What Never Gets Posted

One bad post costs more than ten good ones earn.

— **Client internals.** No screenshots of DataMaster's real data, no internal metrics, no quotes from their team, no repo or environment details. Name the client, generalise everything else.

— **Anything crediting Nawat with pre-2026 work.** The attribution table in Section 07 is not a suggestion.

— **Availability signals.** Never post that work is slow, that you're looking for clients, or that you have capacity. It prices you down instantly. 'Open for new projects' as a permanent site badge is fine, a post saying it is not.

— **The work-volume mechanism.** How you throttle studio work against other commitments stays entirely private, permanently.

— **Named criticism of a person.** Interfaces, never people. Never name the designer.

— **Regional or political commentary.** You are building trust across several countries with different sensitivities. It has no upside for this business.

— **Complaints about clients.** Even anonymised, even funny, even true. Every prospect reading it wonders what you'd say about them.

— **Engagement bait.** 'Agree?' 'Thoughts?' 'Comment YES.' It works briefly and costs the exact credibility this whole document is built on.

— **Anything you can't back.** If a number isn't verified, don't post the number.

THE THIRTY-SECOND CHECK

1. Which pillar is this? If none, don't post it.
2. Would a target client be more likely to hire me after reading this?
3. Is every claim in it something I can prove?
4. Does it critique work rather than people?

5. Would I be comfortable if the team who built this product read it?

PART THREE

Acquisition

How a stranger becomes a client.

Sections 13 to 18. Scripts included. They are meant to be used and edited, not admired.

13

The Ladder

Nobody hires a stranger. So stop being one before you ask for anything.

Your instinct not to slide into a DM with 'can we work together' is correct, and it's worth understanding why so you can defend it when a month goes by with no replies. A cold pitch asks for trust that hasn't been earned and gets refused on principle rather than on merit. The alternative isn't a cleverer pitch. It's arriving already familiar.

FIVE RUNGS

RUNG	WHAT YOU DO	DURATION	THEIR STATE
1. Notice	Find and list the target. Read their product, their posts, their site.	One session	Unaware of you
2. Show up	Comment substantively on their content. Two or three times, spread out. No pitch, no DM.	2 to 3 weeks	Name looks familiar
3. Give	Send the audit Loom. Free, specific, no ask attached.	One message	Owes you attention
4. Talk	They reply. You have a conversation about their product, not your services.	One call	Considering you
5. Propose	Only after they've described a problem they want solved.	One document	Buying

The pitch never happens on rung three. If the Loom ends with a sales ask, you converted a gift into an advertisement.

WHY THE FREE AUDIT WORKS

— **It's a demonstration, not a claim.** They don't have to believe you're good at making dense interfaces clear. They watched you do it, on their own product, for fifteen minutes.

— **It creates obligation without demanding it.** You gave something real and asked for nothing. The social pressure to respond is significant and entirely fair.

— **It qualifies them for you.** How someone responds to critique tells you more about what they'd be like as a client than any call. Defensive means walk away. Curious means proceed.

— **It costs you an afternoon.** Which is the only currency you currently have more of than money.

THE VOLUME MATH

Plan for the real numbers rather than the hopeful ones. From roughly twenty well-targeted audits: eight to twelve replies, four to six conversations, one to three proposals, one client. That ratio is normal and it is not a sign that anything is broken.

At four audits a week that is one new client roughly every five weeks, improving as your content warms the ground ahead of you. Which is the entire reason Part Two comes before Part Three.

14

Finding Them

The list is the work. Everything after it is execution.

WHERE THEY ARE

— **LinkedIn search**, the primary source. Filter by Gulf locations and company size 2 to 200. Search job titles: founder, co-founder, head of product, product manager, CTO. Then filter for companies whose product is software.

— **Hiring signals.** A company posting for a product designer, a front-end developer, or a UX role has both budget and an admitted gap. A company hiring its first designer is the single strongest signal in this entire section.

— **Funding announcements.** Gulf startup news, accelerator cohorts, and regional VC portfolio pages. Newly funded companies rebuild their product within six months of raising.

— **Product directories and app stores.** Filter by region, sort by recency. Open the app. If the interface hurts, that's a lead.

— **Your existing network.** 1.2K LinkedIn connections have been filtered for nothing. Go through them properly once and mark everyone in the Gulf who works at a product company. This costs one evening and it is the warmest list you will ever have.

— **Referrals from DataMaster.** One satisfied client with an ongoing roadmap is a reference you have not yet asked to use. Ask once the current phase ships well.

WHAT MAKES A GOOD TARGET

— The product has real complexity: multiple roles, data tables, workflows, dashboards. Not a landing page with a signup form.

— The interface is visibly unloved, or good in parts and inconsistent across the whole. Inconsistency means no system, which is exactly your offer.

— The company serves Arabic-speaking users, or should and doesn't.

— Small enough that the founder or product lead is reachable and can decide.

— Recent activity: shipping, posting, hiring. A quiet company is a dying company or a slow one.

THE TRACKER

One table, Notion or a spreadsheet, no CRM. Columns: Company · Person · Role · Product · Source · Why they qualify · Rung (1 to 5) · Last touch · Next action · Date. Ten minutes of maintenance a week.

↳ *The most common failure here is not lack of leads, it's losing track of warm ones. A person on rung two who never gets to rung three is worse than never having found them, because you spent the attention and collected nothing.*

THE WEEKLY SOURCING SESSION

1. One hour, same time each week. Add ten new targets to the tracker.
2. For each, note one specific reason they qualify. If you can't write one, they don't.
3. Move everyone on rung two who's had three touches up to rung three this week.
4. Kill anything that's been dormant for six weeks. A clean list is worth more than a long one.

15

The Audit and the Loom

Fifteen minutes of genuine attention is a rarer gift than you think.

BEFORE YOU RECORD

Spend forty-five minutes with the product first. The video is the artefact, but the thinking is the value, and it shows immediately when the thinking hasn't happened.

1. Sign up as a real user. Go through onboarding without skipping. Note where you hesitated.

2. Find the densest screen in the product. That's where your value concentrates.

3. Check it in Arabic if they offer it, and note it if they don't but clearly should.

4. Open it on mobile. Enterprise products almost always break here.

5. Write down three specific findings and one structural observation. Three is the number. Twenty findings reads as a rejection of everything they've built.

THE FIFTEEN-MINUTE STRUCTURE

MINUTES	SECTION	WHAT YOU SAY
0 to 1	Who and why	Name, what you do in one sentence, why you looked at their product specifically. Never generic.
1 to 3	What's working	Genuine and specific. Not flattery. Proves you actually looked.
3 to 11	The three findings	Each: what you noticed, why it costs them something, what you'd do instead. Show it on screen.
11 to 14	The structural point	The pattern underneath the three findings. This is where you sound like a systems designer rather than a critic.

14 to 15	The close	'No pitch here. If it's useful, tell me. If you want the rest of my notes, I'll send them.'

RULES FOR THE RECORDING

— **Face on for the first thirty seconds.** Then screen only. People need to see a person once.

— **Their product on screen the whole time.** Never your portfolio, never slides.

— **Say the cost, not the flaw.** Not 'this table is cluttered.' Instead: 'someone scanning this fifty times a day is reading four columns they never use, and the one they need is furthest right.'

— **Name a constraint you can't see.** 'There's probably a reason this is here that I don't know about.' It signals you've worked with real teams and real trade-offs.

— **Under fifteen minutes.** Twenty feels like homework.

— **One take.** A slightly rough video reads as generous. A polished one reads as marketing.

— **Language: match theirs.** If their product and posts are Arabic, record in Arabic. This alone separates you from every foreign agency approaching them.

THE MISTAKE TO AVOID

Do not redesign anything before they've asked. A mockup turns a gift into a proposal, and a proposal nobody requested is just a pitch with more work in it.

↳ *Describe what you'd change. Don't build it. The gap between your description and their imagination is where they start wanting to hire you.*

16

What to Actually Say

Edit these into your own voice. A script delivered as a script sounds like one.

RUNG TWO — THE COMMENT

The goal is to be recognised, not noticed. Add something they'd have wanted to know.

```
Bad:  Great post! Totally agree.
Good: The part about role permissions is the one most
      teams underestimate. We hit exactly this on an ERP
      build, and it came down to whether roles were a
      filter or a whole different interface. Which way
      did you go?
```

RUNG THREE — THE MESSAGE WITH THE LOOM

Short. The video does the work. No portfolio links, no credentials paragraph, no ask.

```
Hi [Name],

I've been following your posts for a few weeks. I spent
an hour in [Product] this morning and recorded 12 minutes
of notes on the [specific screen], mostly around how the
data is structured and one thing I think is costing your
users time.

[Loom link]

No pitch, nothing attached. I design this kind of
software and your product is the kind I find genuinely
interesting. If it's useful, good. If not, ignore me.

Nadir
```

↳ The word 'interesting' does real work there. It says you chose them, which is the opposite of what a mass outreach message says.

THE ARABIC VERSION

[الاسم] السلام عليكم،
تابعت منشوراتك من فترة. اليوم قضيت ساعة داخل [المنتج] وسجّلت 12 دقيقة ملاحظات على [الشاشة]، خاصة حول طريقة عرض البيانات وحاجة أعتقد أنها تضيّع وقت المستخدمين.
[الرابط]
ما فيه أي عرض ولا طلب. أنا أصمم هذا النوع من المنتجات ومنتجكم من النوع اللي يهمني فعلاً. إذا استفدت منها زين، وإذا لا فلا بأس.
نذير

IF THEY REPLY POSITIVELY

Glad it was useful.

The [structural thing] is the one I'd actually start with, and it's hard to explain in a video. Want to talk it through for 20 minutes this week? No agenda, I just find this kind of problem interesting.

Here's my calendar: [link]

IF THEY DON'T REPLY — ONE FOLLOW-UP, THEN STOP

Ten to fourteen days later, once. Never a second.

Hi [Name], no worries if the timing's wrong. One thing I forgot to mention: [genuinely useful specific tip, ten seconds to read].

Good luck with [specific thing they're working on].

Nadir

↳ *Give something in the follow-up rather than asking again. If there's still no reply, move them to dormant in the tracker and leave them alone. They may come back in six months, and they won't if you chased.*

WHEN SOMEONE APPROACHES YOU

Inbound deserves a different opening. Don't pitch, qualify:

Thanks for reaching out.

Before I say anything useful: what does the product do, who uses it, and what made you start looking for a designer now?

That last one usually tells me the most.

17

The Call and the Proposal

Talk about their problem long enough and the proposal writes itself.

THE DISCOVERY CALL — THIRTY MINUTES

You are diagnosing, not selling. The ratio to hold is roughly seventy percent them, thirty percent you. If you're talking more than they are, the call is going badly regardless of how well you're talking.

1. **Two minutes.** Frame it: 'I want to understand the product properly before I say anything about how I'd work on it.'

2. **Ten minutes, the product.** What does it do, who uses it, how often, what's the hardest screen, what breaks most.

3. **Eight minutes, the pain.** What made you start looking now? What have you tried? What happens if this stays as it is for another year?

4. **Five minutes, the constraints.** Timeline, who decides, who builds it, has anyone designed this before, what's the budget range.

5. **Five minutes, your read.** Say what you think the actual problem is, including if it's not the one they named. Then: 'I'll send you something in two days.'

THE FIVE QUESTIONS THAT MATTER MOST

— **'What made you start looking for a designer now?'** Reveals the real trigger, which is almost never the stated one.

— **'Who else needs to say yes to this?'** Surfaces the hidden decision-maker before you've written a proposal for the wrong person.

— **'What happens if you do nothing?'** If the answer is 'not much,' there's no urgency and the deal will drift forever.

— **'Who's going to build what I design?'** Tells you if handoff quality matters, which is where you're strongest.

— **'What does success look like in six months?'** Their answer becomes the first line of the proposal.

MONEY ON THE CALL

Ask the budget question directly and without apology: 'What range were you thinking for this?' If they deflect, give a range yourself and read the reaction. Never leave a first call without a number in the room, because a proposal written blind is a proposal written twice.

THE ROADMAP STOPS BEING FREE

Your prior process handed over a full roadmap on spec, before any payment, as the thing that earned the yes. That's the single biggest leak in the old pricing model: the actual strategic thinking, the part a client can't get from a template, was the free sample.

New rule: the discovery call still costs nothing and produces only a **lightweight proposal** (Section below) — your read of the problem, a named approach, a price. Not a detailed plan. If a prospect wants the real thing, a properly scoped roadmap with phases, priorities, and a written plan they could theoretically hand to someone else, that is the **Product Audit** package (Section 19). It's small and cheap on purpose, so it's an easy yes, but it is never free.

↳ *This also fixes the qualification problem: a prospect unwilling to pay a small amount for a real roadmap was never going to pay for the build either.*

THE PROPOSAL — SIX PAGES, NEVER MORE

Built in this document template. Sent within two working days, while the call is still warm.

PAGE	SECTION	PURPOSE
1	Cover	Their name, the project, the date. Nawat Studio.
2	What I understood	Their problem in your words, using their language from the call. If this page is right, the rest is nearly decided.
3	The approach	Phases, what happens in each, what they see at the end of each. Not a methodology lecture.
4	What you get	Concrete deliverables. Files, screens, documentation, handoff. Specific counts where possible.
5	Scope and timeline	What's included, what explicitly isn't, how long, what you need from them.
6	Investment and next step	Price, payment schedule, one clear action to accept.

PROPOSAL RULES

— **Page two is the whole document.** If they feel understood, price becomes a detail. If they don't, no price is low enough.

— **Name what's excluded.** Every scope dispute you'll ever have starts with something you assumed was obvious.

— **One option, not three.** Tiered proposals push people to the cheapest tier and make you look uncertain about your own recommendation. If you genuinely need alternatives, offer two: the recommended one and a smaller starting point.

— **Include case-study rights.** A line stating you may publish the work, with names and data generalised at their discretion. Negotiate it now, never after delivery.

— **Put an expiry on it.** 'This scope and price hold for fourteen days.' Not pressure, just a real boundary.

18

When They Push Back

An objection is a question wearing a costume.

THE FIVE YOU'LL HEAR

'IT'S TOO EXPENSIVE'

Almost never about the number. It's about not seeing the value clearly enough to compare. Don't discount, reframe:

That's fair. Can I ask what you're comparing it to? If it's cheaper quotes, the difference is usually documentation and handoff, which is where the cost normally reappears later as developer time. If it's genuinely more than you have, I'd rather cut scope than cut the rate. What's the smallest version of this that would still help?

CUT SCOPE, NEVER RATE

↳ *Discounting teaches the client that your price is fiction, and every future negotiation starts from the discounted number.*

'WE CAN GET THIS CHEAPER'

They can. Say so, then draw the line where it actually is:

Definitely, and for some projects that's the right call. The difference tends to show up at handoff. You'll get screens either way. Whether you get something your developers can build consistently, in both languages, without asking questions for three months, is the part that varies.

AGREE, THEN DIFFERENTIATE

'CAN YOU DO A TEST PROJECT FIRST?'

Yes, if it's paid and scoped. No, if it's free. The audit Loom was already your free work, and doing more free work after it resets the relationship to zero:

I'd rather do a small paid piece than a free trial, and I'd suggest the [specific first phase] as exactly that. It's real work you keep either way, and it tells us both whether this is a good fit before anyone commits to the whole thing.

PAID PILOT, NOT FREE TRIAL

'WE NEED TO THINK ABOUT IT'

Usually means an unspoken concern or a missing decision-maker. Find out which:

Of course. Is it the scope, the timing, the price, or is there someone else who needs to weigh in? I ask because if it's one specific thing, I can probably address it now rather than you spending a week on it.

ISOLATE THE REAL BLOCKER

'ARE YOU A REAL STUDIO OR JUST YOU?'

The honesty guardrail makes this easy. Never dodge it:

It's me leading every project, and I bring in designers I've worked with when a project needs more hands. That's deliberate. You get the person who did the work in the portfolio, not a junior assigned after you sign.

THE HONEST ANSWER IS ALSO THE BETTER ONE

FOLLOW-UP CADENCE AFTER A PROPOSAL

1. **Day 3.** 'Any questions on the proposal?' Nothing more.

2. **Day 8.** Send something useful and unrelated: an article, a relevant example, a thought about their product. No mention of the proposal.

3. **Day 14.** 'Closing the loop on this one so it's not sitting in your inbox. Should I keep the slot or park it?' A clean exit gets more yeses than a chase.

4. **Then stop.** Move to dormant. Revisit in three months with something genuinely new.

WHEN TO WALK

— They want free work after the audit.

— They negotiate the rate more than once.

— The scope grows during the proposal stage, before anything is signed.

— They were dismissive about the audit, then came back wanting a quote.

— Nobody in the conversation can decide.

Say no warmly and leave the door open. The client you decline politely this year refers someone next year.

PART FOUR

Offers & Operations

What you sell, how you deliver it, how you know it's working.

Sections 19 to 25.

19

What Nawat Sells

Named offers with edges. Not 'design services, let's talk.'

Nawat's site currently lists seven services, which is accurate but hard to buy. A founder reading seven options doesn't pick one, they ask for a call and then ask for a custom quote, and you end up scoping from scratch every time. Four named packages with defined edges solve that, and they all remain inside the scope-honesty guardrail because each maps to work you've genuinely shipped.

THE FOUR

01 — PRODUCT AUDIT

— **What it is:** a structured review of an existing product. Heuristic pass, information architecture, density and hierarchy, accessibility check, Arabic and RTL readiness, mobile behaviour.

— **Deliverable:** a written report in this template, a prioritised issue list scored by impact and effort, **a scoped roadmap for what to do next**, and a walkthrough call.

— **Duration:** one to two weeks.

— **Why it exists:** it's the cheapest possible yes, and it's also where the roadmap now lives (Section 17). Under the old process the roadmap was given away free to earn a yes on the full build. Now it's the paid product itself. It converts an audit Loom into a paid engagement without asking anyone to commit to a redesign, and roughly half of them should turn into the next package.

02 — PRODUCT DESIGN

— **What it is:** designing or redesigning a defined part of a product. A module, a workflow, a dashboard, an app. This is the Task Master and B2B Sales ERP shape of work.

— **Deliverable:** user flows, wireframes, final screens with all states, an interactive prototype, developer handoff, and a working session with the engineering team.

— **Duration:** four to eight weeks depending on module count.

— **Scope boundary:** priced per module or per flow, never 'the whole product.' Ambiguous scope is where fixed-price projects go to die.

03 — DESIGN SYSTEM

— **What it is:** the Iksir offer. Token-first foundation, component library with every state, documentation, governance, handoff. Bilingual and accessible from the token layer up.

— **Deliverable:** Figma library, documentation site or pages, token export for developers, governance rules, and a team training session.

— **Duration:** six to twelve weeks depending on component count.

— **This is the flagship.** It's the deepest proof you have and the least commoditised thing you sell. Lead with it whenever the client is large enough to need it.

04 — FULL PROJECT

— **What it is:** identity through to user testing. Nawat's existing 'full spectrum' offer, kept because it's real and because some founders want one partner rather than four decisions.

— **Deliverable:** visual identity, design system, product design, prototype, usability testing, handoff.

— **Duration:** three to five months.

— **Only sell this to a client you've already worked with, or one who arrives with unusual clarity.** It's the highest-risk engagement to run for a stranger.

THE ONGOING OPTION

Design Partner: a monthly arrangement where a client books a defined portion of your time for continuous work. This is what the DataMaster relationship effectively is. Offer it only after a successful project, never as an entry point, and define it in days per month rather than 'availability' so that the boundary is a number and not a feeling.

SCOPE BOUNDARIES THAT APPLY TO EVERYTHING

— Revisions: two rounds per deliverable, named in the proposal. A third round is a change request, not a revision.

— You design, you don't build. Handoff and dev support are included, implementation is not.

— Content and copy are the client's, unless a copywriting scope is explicitly added.

— One point of contact on their side. Design by committee is a scope multiplier disguised as collaboration.

— Client delays pause the timeline. Say this before it happens, not after.

20

Pricing

The number that ends a project below $1,000 was never really a decision. This is.

WHERE YOU WERE, AND WHY IT WASN'T WORKING

Every project so far has closed under $1,000. That's not a reflection of the work, it's a reflection of who the price was being compared to. A freelance UI/UX designer in the general market runs $50 to $150 an hour. A design system specifically, which is your strongest offer, runs **$5,000 to $20,000** freelance and **$10,000 to $50,000** through an agency, scaling with component count, platform coverage, and documentation depth. In the UAE, designers building to a system already bill roughly AED 2,000 to 3,500 a day, about $545 to $950. Iksir, at 1,033 variables and 24 fully-stated bilingual components, sits well inside that five-figure band by market standards, not the sub-€1,000 band the studio was once offered.

You already made the right call once by turning that offer down. This section turns the instinct into a system.

THE MODEL: FIXED PRICE PER PACKAGE

Not hourly, not day rate quoted to the client. Three reasons, and they compound:

— **Hourly punishes expertise.** You built Iksir's foundation efficiently because you'd built systems before. Hourly billing means the better you get, the less you earn for the same result.

— **Fixed price sells to founders.** They're buying an outcome and a budget line, not a timesheet. It removes their biggest fear, which is an open meter.

— **It reads as a studio.** Freelancers quote hours. Studios quote projects. The pricing model is itself a positioning signal.

↳ *The day rate below is an internal costing tool, used to build the fixed prices. It is never quoted to a client directly.*

THE STARTING DAY RATE

$150 to $250 per day, set 2026-08-06. This is a deliberate three-to-five times jump from what closed before, while staying under full Gulf-agency rates until a second and third Nawat case study exist to justify more. Raise it under the rule in the next page, not on a feeling.

THE FORMULA

1. Estimate working days honestly: discovery, revisions, documentation, handoff. Not just screen time.
2. Add 30 percent. Every project runs long, this isn't padding, it's accuracy.
3. Multiply by the day rate above.
4. Sanity-check against value delivered, not just days spent.
5. Round to a clean number. An oddly precise price invites negotiation of the precision.

THE FOUR PACKAGES, PRICED

PACKAGE	EFFORT DAYS	PRICE RANGE	TYPICAL
Product Audit	3 to 5	$600 – $1,600	≈ $900
Product Design (per module)	10 to 20	$2,000 – $6,500	≈ $4,000
Design System	25 to 45	$5,000 – $15,000	≈ $9,000
Full Project	45 to 90	$9,000 – $29,000	≈ $17,000

↳ *Ranges come straight from the formula above at $150 to $250/day. "Typical" assumes a mid-scope project at the middle of the day-rate band. A Design Partner retainer books 5 to 10 days a month at the same rate: roughly $800 to $2,500/month, typically $1,400 to $1,800 for 6 to 8 days.*

THE FLOOR — SET

$600. Below that, decline regardless of circumstances, project size, or how much you want the work.

That number is the low end of the smallest real package, a three-day Product Audit at the bottom of the day-rate band. It's not arbitrary and it's not aspirational, it's the actual cost of your smallest unit of work. It replaces the old sub-$1,000 outcomes with a structured minimum instead of an accidental one. A project that can't clear $600 isn't underpriced, it's the wrong project.

↳ *Never negotiate the floor and never explain it. "That's below what I can take on" is a complete sentence.*

WHAT A MONTH COULD LOOK LIKE

Capacity is deliberately kept project-dependent rather than fixed, so treat these as reference points, not commitments.

COMBINATION	≈ MONTHLY	NOTE
One Product Audit	$900	The lightest possible month. Also the natural first sale from cold outreach.
One Product Design module	$4,000	One clean scope, roughly a month of focused work.
One Design System, spread 2 to 3 months	$3,000 – $4,500	Averaged across the engagement, not paid in one lump.
Audit + Design Partner retainer	$2,300	An audit client who converts to ongoing work.
Two Product Design modules	$7,000 – $9,000	Requires real capacity, not the early-months norm.

↳ *Once real invoices exist, replace this table with what actually happened. A projected table is a planning aid, not a target to defend.*

PAYMENT STRUCTURE

— **Fifty percent before work starts.** Non-negotiable. A client unwilling to commit half is telling you something you should believe.

— **Fifty percent on delivery**, or split across milestones for anything longer than six weeks.

— **Nothing is delivered before final payment clears.** Not files, not the Figma link, not 'just a preview.'

— **Late payment pauses work.** Written into the agreement, applied without drama.

WHEN TO RAISE

— After every second completed project in the first year.

— Whenever you're at capacity — a queue is the market telling you the price is low.

— When a case study ships. Published proof is a price increase you've already earned.

— Never mid-project, and never for an existing client without notice and a reason.

REGIONAL NOTE

You're in Algeria selling to the Gulf. Price to the value delivered in the client's market, not to your cost of living. A Dubai product company comparing you to a Dubai agency is not looking for the cheapest option, they're looking for the one who understands their users. Underpricing against that comparison doesn't win the work, it disqualifies you from it.

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Agreements and Getting Paid

The document nobody reads until the week it matters enormously.

THE INVOICING SETUP

You invoice under your Algerian freelance registration. The client sees Nawat throughout — proposal, delivery, case study — and the invoice is issued under your registered freelance status. This is a legal and administrative mechanism, not a brand split (Section 01).

Practical points to settle once: which currency you invoice in, how international clients pay you, and what documentation your registration requires you to keep. Get these answered by someone who knows Algerian freelance tax rules before the first international invoice, not after.

WHAT EVERY AGREEMENT MUST CONTAIN

- Scope, stated as deliverables with counts, and an explicit exclusions list.
- Timeline, with the condition that client delays extend it.
- Payment: amount, schedule, method, currency, and what happens when payment is late.
- Revisions: how many rounds, and what constitutes a new request rather than a revision.
- Intellectual property: transfers to the client on final payment, not before.
- **Portfolio rights:** you may publish the work as a case study, with specifics generalised at their request. Non-negotiable for early clients.
- Confidentiality, mutual.
- Termination: how either side ends it, and what's owed at that point.
- One named decision-maker on their side.

THE PORTFOLIO CLAUSE MATTERS MOST RIGHT NOW

You have one Nawat case study. The second and third are worth more to the business than the fees that produce them. If a client refuses publication rights entirely, either price the refusal in or decline the work. A silent project builds no compounding asset.

Fallback wording when a client is nervous: you may publish the work with the client unnamed and all data generalised. That's how the DataMaster case studies already handle NDA constraints, and it works.

THE KICKOFF PACK

Sent the day the deposit clears, same four items every time:

1. Signed agreement, countersigned.
2. A one-page project brief: what we're building, what success looks like, who decides.
3. What you need from them, with dates: brand assets, access, users to talk to, technical constraints.
4. The schedule: milestone dates, review points, and delivery date.

↳ *This pack is the single cheapest insurance against scope disputes. Ninety percent of difficult projects become difficult because nobody wrote down what was agreed in week one.*

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How the Work Runs

Predictability is a feature clients pay for and rarely receive.

THE FIVE PHASES

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	THEY SEE	ENDS WHEN
Discover	Interviews, product walkthrough, existing material, user context.	A short findings summary.	You can state their problem better than they can.
Define	IA, flows, structure, the key decisions.	Structure walkthrough and decisions doc.	They approve the structure.
Design	Screens, states, components, the system underneath.	Weekly progress, mid-point review.	Two revision rounds are done.
Validate	Prototype, usability testing where scoped, accessibility pass.	Prototype and findings.	Issues found are fixed or logged.
Hand off	Documentation, tokens, dev session, support window.	Everything, plus a walkthrough.	Developers can build without asking you.

COMMUNICATION RULES

— **One weekly update, same day every week, whether or not there's news.** A client who has to ask for a status update has already started worrying.

— **Async by default.** You work best outside standups and structured office hours, and the honest way to protect that is to over-deliver on written updates rather than to be vaguely unavailable.

— **Reply within one working day.** Not immediately. Set this expectation at kickoff and it becomes a professional standard rather than a delay.

— **Decisions in writing.** Anything agreed on a call gets a one-paragraph summary afterwards. This is not bureaucracy, it's how the last version of the truth stays findable.

— **Show work early and unfinished.** A client who sees week two doesn't panic in week five. Surprise is the enemy, not imperfection.

HANDLING SCOPE CREEP

It arrives as a small friendly question, never as a demand. The response is always the same and it's never confrontational:

Happy to do that. It's outside what we scoped, so it'd be either an addition or a swap for something else in the list. Which would you prefer?

NEVER REFUSE. REPRICE OR TRADE.

↳ *Saying yes for free once teaches the client that scope is decorative. Every subsequent request gets harder to refuse, and resentment starts accumulating on both sides.*

AFTER DELIVERY

1. **Two-week support window** for developer questions. Included, and say so, because it's a real differentiator.

2. **Ask for the testimonial while they're still happy**, not three months later. Specific prompt: 'What was different about working this way?'

3. **Ask for one referral.** 'Who else do you know building something complex?' Once, warmly, no follow-up.

4. **Write the case study within a month**, while the details and the reasoning are still fresh.

5. **Check in at ninety days.** Genuinely, not as a sales move. It's where retainers and second projects come from.

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Working With Others

You manage. They execute. That's the model and it's already been tested.

Nawat's model is honest and unusual: designers join per project rather than sitting on a payroll. Nawat's own site says exactly this, and it's the right claim because it's true. The Iksir project already proved the shape works — a two-person split where you owned strategy, the client relationship, the knowledge layer, and the mobile layer, and your partner owned production work and the documentation build.

RULES FOR BRINGING SOMEONE IN

— **You keep the client relationship.** Always. The client hired your judgement and should never be managed by someone they didn't choose.

— **You own the design decisions.** Freelancers execute defined work. If someone is making the calls, they're a partner and should be paid and credited as one.

— **Brief in writing, always.** What, by when, in which file, to which standard, with which constraints.

— **Pay them regardless of when the client pays you.** Their cash flow is not your client's cash flow. This is what makes people work with you again.

— **Credit them accurately.** The Iksir case study does this correctly. Never take credit for a partner's build, and never let a case study imply a solo effort that wasn't.

— **Never bring in someone unproven on a flagship project.** Test people on lower-stakes work first.

WHEN TO BRING SOMEONE IN

— The project needs a skill you'd otherwise be learning on the client's budget.

— The volume is genuinely beyond your hours, and the alternative is a missed deadline.

— The work is well-defined enough that briefing it costs less time than doing it. If briefing takes longer than doing, do it yourself.

WHAT TO NEVER OUTSOURCE

— Discovery and client conversations.

— Structural and system decisions.

— Anything that goes in a case study as your thinking.

— The audit Looms. The whole point is that you looked.

The moment a client can't tell whether they hired you or a marketplace, the position is gone.

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Knowing If It's Working

Measure the actions you control, not the outcomes you hope for.

THE WEEKLY NUMBERS — FRIDAY, TEN MINUTES

METRIC	TARGET	WHY THIS ONE
Posts published	3	The only content number fully in your control.
Substantive comments	50	Ten a working day. The highest-leverage habit in the document.
New targets added	10	Keeps the pipeline from emptying silently.
Audits sent	3 to 4	The direct input to client count.
Replies received	Track it	Tells you whether the audits or the targeting need work.
Conversations held	1 to 2	The real leading indicator of revenue.
Proposals sent	Track it	

THE MONTHLY REVIEW — ONE HOUR

1. Where did every conversation this month originate? Content, audit, referral, inbound? Do more of whichever produced most.

2. Which posts got real responses, not just impressions? A comment from a target client outranks a thousand views.

3. Reply rate on audits. Under 30 percent means the targeting is wrong, not the video.

4. Proposal win rate. Under a third means either the price or the qualification is off, and the discovery call is where to look.

5. Revenue against the month's target.

6. One thing to stop doing. Every month. Non-negotiable.

THE QUARTERLY QUESTIONS

— Is the positioning still true? Has the work drifted away from what Part One claims?

— How many Nawat-attributed case studies exist now? If the answer hasn't changed in six months, something is structurally wrong.

— Has the price gone up? If not, why not?

— Which channel is producing least, and should it be cut?

— Is the workload still compatible with how you actually want to work? The whole reason for this path was that structured full-time employment didn't suit you. A studio that recreates that is a failure even if it's profitable.

WHAT NOT TO MEASURE

Follower count, impressions, likes, profile views. They move for reasons unrelated to whether anyone will hire you, and optimising for them will quietly pull your content away from the four pillars and toward whatever performs. A post with 200 views that starts one conversation with a Riyadh product lead beat a post with 20,000 views that started none.

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The First Ninety Days

Everything above is useless without a first Monday.

WEEKS 1 TO 2 — SET UP, DON'T LAUNCH

- Update all bios and headlines from the copy bank (Section 04).
- Build the three social frames in Figma, both scripts, both themes (Section 06).
- Build the tracker (Section 14) and add the first thirty targets.
- Go through the 1.2K LinkedIn connections and flag everyone in the Gulf at a product company.
- Settle pricing: day value, the four package prices, and the floor. Write them into Section 20.
- Write the proposal template and the agreement template in this document's style.

WEEKS 3 TO 6 — CONTENT ONLY

- Publish three posts a week, every week. No exceptions, no perfect posts.
- Comment on ten posts every working day. This is the priority, above publishing.
- Reach rung two with fifteen targets: seen your name, seen your comments.
- Publish the first two Behance decks, spaced two weeks apart.
- Send zero audits. This period is only about not being a stranger.

↳ *The discipline of not pitching for a month is the hardest part of this plan and the reason it works. Every audit sent in week three lands on someone who has never heard of you.*

WEEKS 7 TO 12 — OUTREACH BEGINS

- Send three to four audit Looms a week, only to targets already on rung two.
- Maintain content at three posts and fifty comments a week. Do not let outreach eat content.

- Hold every conversation that comes from a reply, even the unpromising ones. Early ones are practice.
- Send proposals within two working days of any call.
- Target by day ninety: one signed client, ideally a Product Audit as the entry point.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE AT NINETY DAYS

— Roughly 36 posts published and about 600 substantive comments left.

— 60 to 80 qualified targets in the tracker, 20 to 25 audits sent.

— 6 to 10 real conversations held.

— One or two clients signed, and the second Nawat case study underway.

— And the thing that doesn't appear in any metric: a handful of people in Dubai, Riyadh, and Doha who now know exactly who you are and what you do.

THE MOST LIKELY WAY THIS FAILS

Not lack of skill and not lack of a plan. It fails if weeks three to six get skipped because outreach feels more productive than commenting, or if content stops the moment the first client arrives and the pipeline is empty again in three months.

The content and the outreach are one system. Running either alone produces a fraction of what running both produces.

You already do the work.

This is just the part where people find out.

Nadir & Nawat — Brand & Operating System

Version 1.0 · August 2026

Review quarterly. Update the week a decision changes, not the month after.